YU ZHOU

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EXPERIENCE

Meta Superintelligence Labs *2026*
Research Scientist Intern
- *Peers: Christoph Feichtenhofer, Zi-Yi Dou, Bernie Huang, Daniel Bolya, Chay Ryali*
- Grounding post-training for Muse Spark and data pipelines for next generation MLLMs.

Apple *2025 - 2026*
Research Collaboration
- *Peers: Zhe Gan, Yinfei Yang, Zhen Yang, Ruiyi Zhang, Hong-You Chen*
- OpenVLHarness: Real-World Visual Agentic Tool-Use with Multimodal Memory.
- Benchmarking extremely subtle and precise embodied perception capabilities of MLLMs.

Meta Superintelligence Labs *2025*
Research Scientist Intern
- *Peers: Pengchuan Zhang, Kate Saenko, Shoubhik Debnath, Didac Suris Coll-Vinent, Nicolas Carion*
- Agentic tool-use with SAM 3 to ground complex referring expressions and reasoning-based queries.

Stanford University *2024*
Visiting Researcher
- *Mentors: Manling Li, Jiajun Wu, Fei-Fei Li*
- Holistically evaluate MLLMs for dynamic world modeling and embodied decision making.
- Build large-scale virtual simulation datasets and decision making interface for embodied agents.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *2023*
Research Intern
- *Peers: Manling Li, Sha Li, Xudong Lin*
- Training models for non-sequential procedural planning from large-scale video and text data.

EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles *2024 - Present*
Ph.D. in Computer Science
Advisors: Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng

University of California, Los Angeles *2019 - 2023*
B.S. in Mathematics, minor in Data Engineering

SELECTED WORKS

OpenVLHarness: Real-World Visual Agentic Tool-Use with Multimodal Memory *Preprint*
Yu Zhou, Cheng-Fu Yang*, Rui Sun*, Di Wu*, Sibo Peng, Mingyang Zhang, Zhen Yang, Ruiyi Zhang, Nanyun Peng, Zhe Gan, Kai-Wei Chang*

Muse Spark: Scaling Towards Personal Superintelligence *Technical Blog*
Meta MSL Team

Does Inference-Time Reasoning Really Improve Video Understanding? *NeurIPS 2026*
*Zhuohao Yu, **Yu Zhou**, Zhecan Wang, Rui Sun, Wei Ye, Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng*

SAM 3: Segment Anything with Concepts *ICLR 2026*
Meta SAM 3 Team

ENACT: Evaluating Embodied Cognition with World Modeling of Egocentric Interaction *ICLR 2026*
Outstanding Paper Awards at ICLR 2026 World Models Workshop and Lifelong Agents Workshop
Qineng Wang, Wenlong Huang*, **Yu Zhou**, Hang Yin, Tianwei Bao, Jianwen Lyu, Weiyu Liu, Ruohan Zhang, Jiajun Wu, Li Fei-Fei, Manling Li*

TemMed-Bench: Evaluating Temporal Medical Image Reasoning in Vision-Language Models *COLM 2026*
*Junyi Zhang, Jiachen Gu, Wenbo Hu, **Yu Zhou**, Robinson Piramuthu, Nanyun Peng*

Contrastive Visual Data Augmentation *ICML 2025*
***Yu Zhou**[*], Bingxuan Li[*], Mohan Tang[*], Xiaomeng Jin, Te-Lin Wu, Kuan-Hao Huang, Heng Ji, Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng*

Embodied Agent Interface: Benchmarking LLMs for Embodied Decision Making *NeurIPS 2024* ***(Oral)***
Best Paper Award at SoCal NLP Symposium 2024 (1 / 166 accepted papers)
*Manling Li[*], Shiyu Zhao[*], Qineng Wang[*], Kangrui Wang[*], **Yu Zhou**[*] (equal contribution), Sanjana Srivastava, Cem Gokmen, Tony Lee, Li Erran Li, Ruohan Zhang, Weiyu Liu, Percy Liang, Li Fei-Fei, Jiayuan Mao, Jiajun Wu*

Localizing Active Objects from Egocentric Vision with Symbolic World Knowledge *EMNLP 2023* ***(Oral)***
*Te-Lin Wu[*], **Yu Zhou**[*] (equal contribution), Nanyun Peng*

Non-Sequential Graph Script Induction via Multimedia Grounding *ACL 2023*
***Yu Zhou**, Sha Li, Manling Li, Xudong Lin, Shih-Fu Chang, Mohit Bansal, Heng Ji*

LLMs as Scalable, General-Purpose Simulators For Evolving Digital Agent Training *LAW @ NeurIPS 2025*
*Yiming Wang[*], Da Yin[*], Yuedong Cui[*], Ruichen Zheng[*], Zhiqian Li, Zongyu Lin, Di Wu, Xueqing Wu, Chenchen Ye, **Yu Zhou**, Kai-Wei Chang*

DialectGen: Benchmarking and Improving Dialect Robustness in Multimodal Generation *ResponsibleFM @ NeurIPS 2025*
***Yu Zhou**, Sohyun An, Haikang Deng, Da Yin, Clark Peng, Cho-Jui Hsieh, Kai-Wei Chang, Nanyun Peng*

ARMADA: Attribute-Based Multimodal Data Augmentation *WikiNLP @ ACL 2024*
*Xiaomeng Jin, Jeonghwan Kim, **Yu Zhou**, Kuan-Hao Huang, Te-Lin Wu, Nanyun Peng, Heng Ji*

Iterative Strict Density-Based Clustering for News Stream *CCIR 2021*
*Kaijie Shi, Jiaxin Shi, **Yu Zhou**, Lei Hou, Juanzi Li*

Measurement methods of radial flow in relativistic heavy-ion collisions *Physical Review C*
*Peng Yang, Lin Li, **Yu Zhou**, Zhiming Li, Mingmei Xu, Yeyin Zhao, Yuanfang Wu*

Machine learning phase transitions of the three-dimensional Ising universality class *Chinese Physics C*
*Xiaobing Li, Ranran Guo, **Yu Zhou**, Kangning Liu, Jia Zhao, Fen Long, Yuanfang Wu, Zhiming Li*

Investigations into the characteristics and influences of nonequilibrium evolution *Physical Review C*
*Xiaobing Li, Mingmei Xu, Yanhua Zhang, Zhiming Li, **Yu Zhou**, Jinghua Fu, Yuanfang Wu*

Locating fixed points in the phase plane *Physical Review E*
*Yanhua Zhang, Yeyin Zhao, Lizhu Chen, Xue Pan, Mingmei Xu, Zhiming Li, **Yu Zhou**, Yuanfang Wu*

Relaxation behavior near the first-order phase transition line *Physical Review E*
*Xiaobing Li, Ranran Guo, Mingmei Xu, Jinghua Fu, Lizhu Chen, **Yu Zhou**, Yuanfang Wu*

AWARDS

Jun 2026 Amazon AI PhD Fellowship

Apr 2026 Outstanding paper award at ICLR 2026 World Models Workshop

Apr 2026 Outstanding paper award at ICLR 2026 Lifelong Agents Workshop

Dec 2025 Spotlight at NeurIPS 2025 Language, Agent, and World Models Workshop

Dec 2024 Oral presentation at NeurIPS 2024 (Top 0.4%)

Nov 2024 Best paper award at SoCal NLP Symposium 2024 (1 / 166 Accepted Papers)

Sept 2024 UCLA Graduate Student Fellowship

May 2024 Cohere AI Research Grant

SERVICES

Workshop Organizer: Foundation Models Meet Embodied Agents @ CVPR 2025

Challenge Organizer: Embodied Agent Interface Challenge @ NeurIPS 2025

Reviewer: JMLR, NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML, CVPR, ECCV, COLM, AAAI, ACL, EMNLP

Teaching: CS146 Machine Learning, CS263 Natural Language Processing

TALKS

Oct 2026 Amazon Science Hub, California NanoSystems Institute (CNSI)

Jan 2026 Nuclear Physics Group, UCLA

Nov 2025 Information Sciences Institute (ISI), USC

Aug 2025 Salesforce AI Research Future Forum